SpeechGeek

# Season One: Fall 2003

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**SpeechGeek**
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It is my pleasure to welcome you to the first issue of **SpeechGeek.com**. You may be asking why would we choose a URL as our title? The answer is quite simple. Our goal is to not only use this periodical as a means of furthering forensic performance, but to also create a paper and online environment that aids students at all forensic levels. We believe our material is top quality and ready to help you begin your journey toward becoming a champion. These scripts allow both students and coaches room to be expressive and add his or her own individual ideas. We believe you should be spending your time performing, not looking for quality material. We would love to hear your comments about our first issue. Best of luck as your season begins!

**Corey Alderdice**
**Publisher**

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# Canada, Eh!

by Frank and Jack Walston

**NARR.** We begin our story with a...story. (very spectacularish) A long time ago in a barren land filled with great wonder and delight, there lived a wee little man who loved everything around him. The trees, the earth, the cold, cold winters and everything aboot his home land. That's why you should come to Canada...because a wee little man told you to.

**EXEC.** Nice...I love that feeling of patriotism...yes...proud to be a Canadian. Ahem...so how did the commercial run with the test audiences?

**ASST.** Umm...sir...the only positive results we had were with chimpanzees and algae...

**EXEC.** WHY IS THAT?

**ASST.** Well sir it's just not appealing to any 'human' audience...

**EXEC.** What does this mean, eh?

**ASST.** Basically, primates and algae don't spend the dough so I guess the commercial is being pulled.

**EXEC.** We really have to do something here...I could lose my job...my car...my house...my flannel hat!!

**ASST.** Sir, I think I have an idea.

**EXEC.** Yes? Out with it.

**ASST.** Well while I am frequently watching American television I notice that their advertising campaigns are...well...entertaining...not boring...funny...intelligent...creative..

**EXEC.** I get the point. What are you saying?

**ASST.** (Whispers) Let's hire Americans to make our PR campaigns...that way we don't look so bad...

**EXEC.** OUI!!...I mean YES!! I love it. Lets get on the phone.

**JOEL.** Good afternoon ladies and gentlemen. On behalf of In Your Face Advertising, it is my pleasure to be here.

**COREY.** Thank you Joel. My name is Corey and you good people at the Canadian Ministry of Tourism have asked our firm to give your nation a public relations makeover.

**JOEL.** That's right. Here are the profit numbers from tourism last year. Zero (hold up a zero)

**COREY.** Fixable...definitely fixable

**JOEL.** Wait a minute. That's not right. (holds up negative one billion) Negative one billion...right.

**COREY.** Okay folks that's just bad-(bewildered look)

**JOEL.** Moving along, we have several ideas that will give your country a nice kick in the pants. So if you're ready, let's begin. We feel it's best to appeal to a new generation. It worked for Pepsi. It worked for Star Trek: The Next Generation. "N-E-X-T" Generation...see what I'm saying? Hmm...you know what I'm talking about.

**COREY.** You have to give kids what they want. They don't want their grandma's Canada. They want C-N-D wit duh triple A's mixed in...word.

**JOEL.** (aside) That means Canada.

**COREY.** Here's a little rap aboot a land called Canada. It's got lots of moose, but we ain't got pan-uh-das...

**JOEL.** (cuts off) That doesn't even make sense. What I think you were going for is, pandas?

**COREY.** Look I'm the one bustin' the lyrical rhymes YO! You stick to the beat ah-

ig-it?
Hip Hop rap to the dag dawg diggity/
It might be cold but we ain't shivery.
Cruisin all around quite like a thief/
When we hail our flag we hail the maple leaf.
Hip hop rap to the Mix Master Sinister/
We cooler than the States cause we gots a Prime Minister…

**JOEL.** We ain't finished here, just up to Prime Minister. (scratch) Wikky wikky, Prime Minister.

**COREY.** Go dizzown t'da grocery, stuff's labelled in French. You laugh at our metrics; but wad up with 'dat inch?

**JOEL.** Ha Ha you use the inch…

**COREY.** So raise up that Maple Leaf, give props to the red and whizzite. Say, waddup Canada! This country's out of sight. (finish with robot dance)

**JOEL.** All right, that could be a little too much, so let's put that one in the maybe pile.

**COREY.** How about, or should I say 'aboot', (laughs) I always kill myself.

**JOEL.** If you don't get on with it, I'll do it for you.

**COREY.** How about we move along to the most troubled spots in your country? The whole thing. For years Canada has been the Vancouver Grizzlies of the tourism world.

**JOEL.** Corey, I hate to break this to you, but the NBA moved the Grizzlies to Memphis.

**COREY.** My point exactly. We feel the best way to deal with this problem is to simply bite the bullet and be honest with the public. After all, honesty is the best policy. Isn't that what we learned from Abraham Lincoln?

**JOEL.** Was that before or after John Wilkes Booth shot him in the head?

**COREY.** We're oozing-lay edibility-cray.

**JOEL.** Sorry. Here are the new billboards for the Canada, Eh! campaign.

**COREY.** Okay then…what have we got here then? Hmm, I call this a big 'ole bag of slogans!
Canada: It's a Dry Cold.

**JOEL.** Canada: What Else is Above America?

**COREY.** Canada: Come See Our Beavers!

**JOEL.** Got Canada? No? Well You Should!

**COREY.** We think this last one is really going to set off the whole campaign. You've arrived in Canada Sorry Aboot That!

**JOEL.** Alrighty…so maybe honesty isn't the best policy. Well, this next idea is going to knock you all flat on your ice hockey-loving frozen butts.

**COREY.** Way to put that so eloquently. What my esteemed colleague meant to say is we want to show that Canada isn't a nation of big ole pansies, with police who ride horses…I mean which is cool and all but we just want to point out the greatest moment in Canadian history: the time when Canada kicked America's butt.

**COREY.** I think we should go with some sort of historical motif. Like a re-enactment. Something hip fresh and cool. *Saving Private Ryan*ish… hmm?

**GENERAL**. Alright there, eh. Umm..so let's see. Guns, eh?

**SOLDIER.** Check, eh!

**GENERAL.** Bullets, eh?

**SOLDIER.** No check there, eh.

**GENERAL.** No bullets, eh?

**SOLDIER.** Nope, eh.

**GENERAL.** What kind of military sends out troops without bullets, eh?

**SOLDIER.** A Canadian one.

**GENERAL.** Let's let the Brits take care of the war and we'll go burn down some buildings, eh.

**SOLDIER.** What aboot this White House, eh?

**GENERAL.** How aboot it, eh?

**JOEL.** And so you see that's how Santa Claus invented Christmas.

**COREY.** I thought it was how their country defeated us! I don't think they liked it either way.

**JOEL.** Maybe it just hit a little too close to home.

**COREY.** Shut up! Maybe it's just because we mock them so much...

**JOEL.** Ummm...NO...they just don't like war re-enactments. Why don't we try and give them something that they can be proud of. Something that we haven't thought of yet, something...something thats fun, violent, and involves BEER.

**COREY.** Something like Hockey!

**ANN. 1.** Good evening ladies and gentlemen. With the sound of that crazy Polish muzack, you know it's time for the Canadian Broadcasting Corporation's, "Wednesday Afternoon Hockey...Game Thing"

**ANN. 2.** And we've got a humdinger of a game for you all this evening. It's the Yanks versus the Canucks in a battle royale.

**ANN. 1.** That's right. This is much more than a hockey match tonight.

**ANN. 2.** Good one Bill...you might even call it a war.

**ANN. 1.** The puck's on the ice and this game is underway. Earlier we spoke to the coach for the American squad, President James Madison.

**MADISON.** Tonight's match-up isn't just any game. It's an all out war. We're declaring war on Great Britain and all her dependencies, and that includes Canada. We're the dominant force in the New World and no little Canuck squad will end our Manifest Destiny.

**ANN. 1.** Strong words from a strong country, and Madison may be right. The Canadian squad features only seven battalions with a total of 5600 soldiers—each of them missing at least three teeth.

**ANN. 2.** Take a look at that hit. You might want to round that up to four. The Americans are really handing them some major punishment. The Maple Leaf Mayhem has called a timeout and it looks like they're sending in British reinforcements to guard the Great Lakes.

**ANN. 1.** That's right. These small and efficient regiments with skilled leadership might give the Canadians an edge.

**ANN. 2.** It's the year 1814 and time is running out. It looks like the Canucks are making their move. They shake left. They bake right...and...could it be....GOAL!!! At the buzzer! The Canucks win! The Canucks win!

**ANN. 1.** This crowd is going wild! They're not only tearing apart the stadium, they're burning down the White House. This one's going down in the history books!

**JOEL.** Huh...Huh...what do you guys think? Now if you think that was good, let's take things up a notch. Canada cannot be seen simply as a mere redheaded stepchild lost in the aisles of Kmart (both laugh extremely hard. Then notice that the Canadians don't get it.) Uh huh...okay what we mean to say is that...

**COREY.** We need to strike fear into the hearts of those who would oppose you.

**JOEL.** (say like wrestler) We want total domination...

**ANN.** The following is a message for all Canadians age 4 to 182.

**KEANU.** Hello, I'm Keanu Reeves.

**CELINE.** I'm Celine Dion.

**SKATERS.** And we're the 2002 Olympic gold medal figure skaters Jamie Sale and

David Pelletier.

**KEANU.** We'd like to tell you about CWD.

**CELINE.** (say like wrestler) Canadian World Domination.

**KEANU.** Do you find that even though your nation occupies seven percent of the world's landmass and nine percent of the fresh water supply, you're still the whipping boy of those Anglo-bastards?

**SKATERS.** Do your neighbors to the south snicker when you proudly announce your national animal is a beaver?

**CELINE.** Do you ever randomly break into "My Heart Will Go On," the Academy Award winning song from the motion picture "Titanic"?

**KEANU.** Don't just stand there and take that crap. With the help of Canadian World Domination, you can do something about it.

**SKATERS.** If someone says that lacrosse isn't a real sport, you can complain to the International Olympic Committee that it's an international conspiracy induced by the Russian mafia.

**CELINE.** If someone says the last letter of the alphabet is pronounced 'zee' and not 'zed,' just start singing my hit song "That's the Way it Is."

**KEANU.** Or if someone laughs at Canadian towns named Climax, Love, Prince Albert, Pilot Butte, or Ottawa, get all Matrix on their red, white and blue back sides.

**CELINE.** And let them know you're proud to be a member of CWD!

**ALL.** But remember as Canadians we all have a duty as citizens of this fine nation to not piss off any other country for fear of hostile takeover or nuclear annihilation. CWD…it works!

**ANN.** This has been a message for Canadian World Domination.

**COREY.** Now that's more like it. Next, we want to deal with the issue of Quebec.

**JOEL.** What's that? You say Quebec isn't even a real part of Canada because you constantly have to bribe them to stay a part of the country, their hockey team is made up of dirty Frenchmen, and they take bets on which English neighbour will move out of the city next?

**COREY.** Well, it seems as though that's a pretty sore spot, so let's move on to the grand finale. We want something that appeals to all ages. Something that says, "Hug me. I'm a Canadian."

**JOEL.** Something like Benny the Canadian Beaver.

**BENNY.** (at this same time the other actor should be humming either "O Canada" or "God Save The Queen") Hello global citizens. I want to you tell you a little about myself. I'm not a lumberjack or fur trader. I don't live in an igloo or ride a dogsled. And I don't know Bill, or Janet, or Suzie, or Chuck from Canada. However, I'm sure they are very nice people. I have a Prime Minister, which just sounds cooler than president. I speak English and French. And I pronounce it aboot, not 'aboot.' I believe in making peace, hockey and beer, not war. I believe in diversity and not assimilation. AND THAT THE BEAVER IS A PROUD AND NOBLE ANIMAL.

**BOY.** Hehehehehe…He said beaver.

**BENNY.** Ahem…yes I did say beaver. I believe a toque is a hat, a chesterfield is a couch, and it is pronounced 'zed' and not 'zee'…It's zed…zed…zed…zed! Sorry. Canada is the second largest landmass. The first nation of hockey! My name is Benny and I am proud to be a Canadian. Are you? Eh?

**COREY.** That concludes our presentation for the NEW CANADA. We hope you all have enjoyed our material.

**ASST.** (assistant comes running in) Wait just one curling playing minute! We

don't need the American's anymore.

**COREY.** Why?

**ASST.** Look at the headline of this American tabloid. (reads) "American Movie Star Ben Afleck's X-Rated Romp in Vancouver Nightclub Leads to J-Lo Split." Now everyone will come to our glorious county. We'll no longer be the *Gigli* of the tourism industry!

**COREY.** How about this headline? (hand paper over)

**ASST.** "SARS Infects Canada." Well, how about this one. "American Film Industry Shifts to Toronto."

**COREY.** All right...what would say about this photo of your Prime Minister in a compromising situation with a moose?

**ASST.** Deal. We'll pay you one million (coughs) Canadian dollars.

**JOEL.** Deal. Did you say Canadian dollars?

**COREY.** Way to go genius. What could be worse than getting hoodwicked by Canadians?

**JOEL.** Ending with a bad joke?

**COREY.** You might as well go ahead.

**JOEL.** I guess you can't win them all, eh?

***Editor's note: While the script notes the two main characters' names are Joel and Corey, feel free to substitute Jill for Joel if the performer is a female. Corey can also be a female name, so there's no need for the change for that name.***